Chittenden Central Merger Committee Agenda #2

Nov 2, 2026
Craig Aarons-Martin Dave Younce nimace@wsdvt.org

Merger committee adopted representation and discussed asset mapping and work plans.

Committee Membership and Representation

- Nicole Mace called the meeting to order at 4:03 p.m.
- The committee affirmed scenario A establishing 6 representatives for proportional representation.
- New members Claire Wool, Lucia Campriello, Kendra Sowers, Seamus Abshere, and Daniel Boyer joined the committee.

Work Plan and Timeline

- Nicole Mace presented a 10-month work plan aligned with agency data availability.
- The committee agreed to fast-track foundations and shared vision phases to allow deeper data analysis.
- The schedule prioritizes the options and analysis phase for January and February.

Regional Asset Mapping Protocol

- Craig Aarons-Martin introduced the regional asset mapping reference tool to identify community strengths and resources.
- The committee agreed to use an Excel spreadsheet to document community strengths, programs, and resource gaps.

Regional asset and gap mapping framework

- Craig Aarons-Martin provided a digital dashboard template to map community strengths and gaps across districts.
- Members prioritized academic and educational opportunities as the primary lens for the asset mapping exercise.
- Seamus Abshere noted South Burlington offers 27 AP classes alongside established academic traditions.
- Nicole Mace highlighted Wooki employs a dedicated flexible pathways and work-based learning coordinator.
- Lucia Campriello emphasized pairing objective academic data with qualitative metrics regarding equitable student access.
- Nicole Mace and Lucia Campriello added safety, belonging, and leadership effectiveness as evaluation lenses.

Public communication and committee transparency

- Kendra Sowers raised concerns regarding community confidentiality and preventing misunderstandings about exploratory study discussions.

- Clare Wool and Daniel Boyer emphasized that the study committee holds no decision-making power.
- Nicole Mace noted that committee materials are public record and advised using AOE small number suppression rules.
- Clare Wool urged members to preview materials with local school boards to avoid community surprises.

Upcoming committee schedule and logistics

- The committee scheduled the next in-person meeting for December 7 at 4:00 PM at Champlain Elementary School.

Next steps

[Caitlin MacLeod-Bluver] Send Public Comment: Submit the public comment in an email to Nicole Mace.

[Nicole Mace] Share Webinar Info: Distribute the webinar information regarding the committee structure to all members.

[The group] Distribute Data Template: Send the data collection template to district administrative teams for completion before the January 4 meeting.

[Craig Aarons-Martin] Compile Data: Collect and compile the completed data templates from all participating districts for review.

[Craig Aarons-Martin] Provide Asset Spreadsheet: Upload the Excel file for asset mapping to the committee folder by this evening.

[The group] Populate Asset Map: Add community strengths and gaps to the shared Excel spreadsheet before the December 7th meeting.

[The group] Gather Board Feedback: Present the study committee progress and asset mapping data to local school boards to facilitate community engagement and transparency.

[Seamus Abshere] Coordinate Meeting Location: Consult with Joe to confirm a venue for the January committee meeting.

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Invited Craig Aarons-Martin Dave Younce nimace@wsdvt.org

Attachments Chittenden Central Merger Committee Agenda #2 Chittenden Central Merger Committee Agenda #2

Meeting records Transcript Recording

Summary

Merger committee adopted representation and discussed asset mapping and work plans.

Proportional Representation Decision
Adoption of Scenario A representation passed unanimously across all voting members.

Decisions

Aligned

- **Adoption of six-member committee representation** The committee voted to adopt scenario A, establishing six total representatives for the merger study committee.
- **Adoption of Shared Asset Mapping Dashboard** The committee aligned on using a shared digital dashboard containing tabs for each district to map regional assets and gaps.
- **Prioritization of Academics in Asset Mapping** The committee aligned on prioritizing academics and educational opportunities as the primary lens for the asset and gap mapping exercise.

Next steps

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Details

Questions Log and Work Plan Introduction: Nicole Mace and Craig Aarons-Martin discussed the draft work plan, with Nicole Mace sharing a questions log in the shared folder to organize ongoing inquiries without requiring immediate answers. Craig Aarons-Martin noted that Dave reviewed the work plan and found it solid, emphasizing the need for scheduling flexibility prior to writing the final plan as long as work is frontloaded (00:01:18).

Call to Order and Meeting Opening: Nicole Mace formally called the merger study committee meeting to order at 4:03 p.m. with all member representatives in attendance (00:05:44).

Committee Member Introductions: Committee members introduced themselves, including Clare Wool (Burlington School Board Chair, serving since April 2022 with one year remaining in their term), Lucia Campriello (representing Burlington Ward 5 residents, serving since April 2022 with one year left), Kendra Sowers (North District School Commissioner in Burlington, serving their eighth year and chairing the finance and facilities committee), Seamus Abshere (South Burlington School Board Chair, serving for two years), Daniel Boyer (South Burlington School Board member, serving about two years), and Nicole Mace (Winooski School Board Chair, serving for three years with two years remaining in their term, bringing prior experience from ten years at the Vermont School Boards Association during Act 46) (00:08:01).

Public Comment and Approval of October Minutes: Caitlin MacLeod-Bluver intended to offer public comment but could not attend due to childcare and driving commitments, noting they would submit comments via email, while Wilmer Chavarria attended simply to listen (00:10:13). Clare Wool moved to approve the October meeting minutes, seconded by Seamus Abshere, and the minutes were approved by the eligible members who attended the initial meeting (00:11:25).

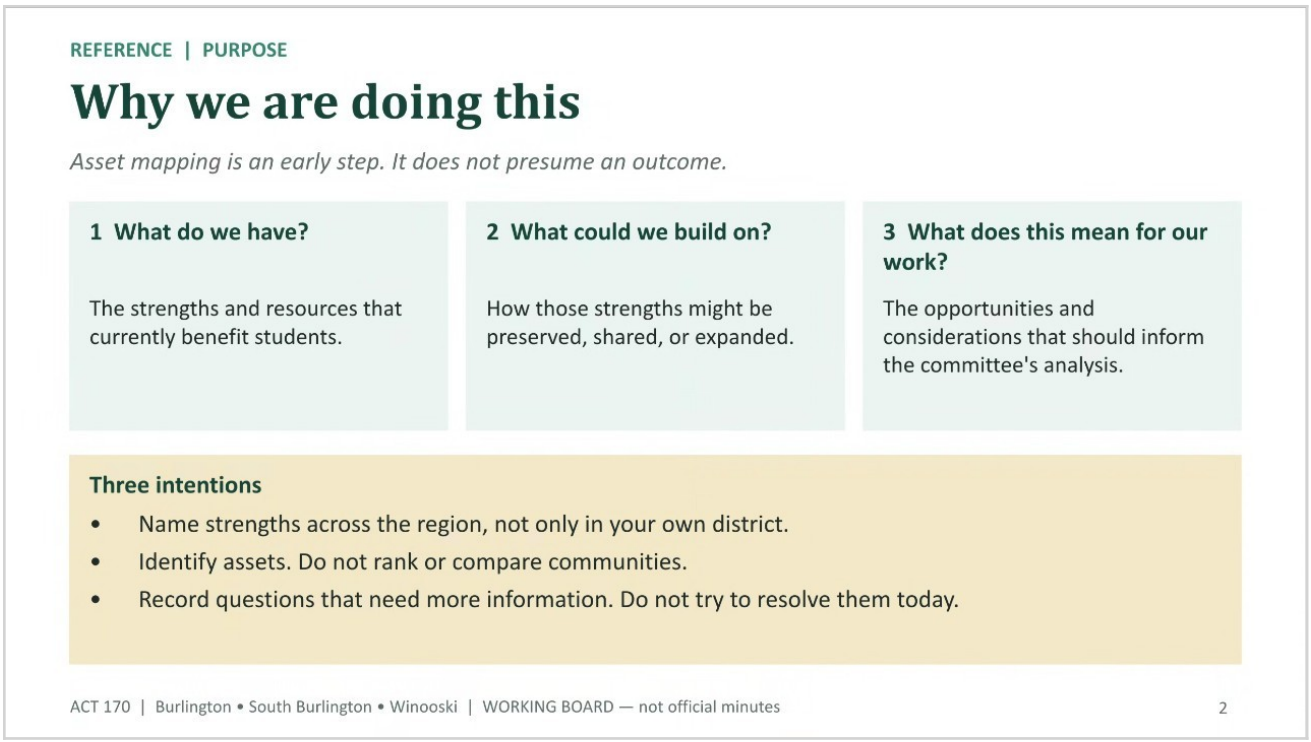
Committee Operating Principles and Student Engagement: Craig Aarons-Martin reviewed operating principles established in the previous meeting, which emphasize leading with students, challenging ideas rather than individuals, using evidence before conclusions, presuming good faith, honoring local voice and regional responsibility, and sharing transparency (00:12:33). Kendra Sowers asked how student feedback is incorporated, prompting Nicole Mace to explain that Winooski dedicates the first hour of every board meeting to merger updates and uses student board members to lead advisory activities in local schools, while broader outreach strategies remain open for future discussion (00:14:21).

Good Faith Standard and Proportional Representation Decision: Craig Aarons-Martin reviewed the good faith participation guidance, clarifying that good faith does not require supporting or opposing a merger, but rather active engagement, challenging assumptions, and sharing requested information. Nicole Mace reviewed proportional representation based on long-term weighted membership counts, noting that Superintendent Wilmer Chavarria previously presented Scenario A (six total members) and Scenario B (10 members) (00:15:39). Because Seamus Abshere had to leave early during the organizational meeting, Nicole Mace and Clare Wool had selected Scenario A to maintain quorum and practical considerations. Seamus Abshere formally moved to adopt Scenario A representation, seconded by Clare Wool, and the motion passed unanimously across all voting members (00:17:29).

Draft Work Plan Framework and Community Perspectives: Nicole Mace introduced a draft work plan based on an Agency of Education memo, structured around a ten-month timeline and ten total meetings (00:20:31). Seamus Abshere suggested introducing merger options early and conducting a "pulse check" to break the ice regarding community expectations (00:22:07). Lucia Campriello, Clare Wool, Kendra Sowers, and Nicole Mace discussed the importance of maintaining open minds, prioritizing student opportunity over cost savings, and avoiding premature community polling that lacks context (00:26:32). Clare Wool noted that communities had a prior statutory window to object to the pairing (00:28:53), and Seamus Abshere highlighted that South Burlington passes budgets by narrow margins (51% to 52%) compared to higher margins in other districts (65% to 80%), creating distinct community urgency (00:30:58). Nicole Mace and Seamus Abshere discussed the division of responsibilities between the committee analyzing data and local school boards communicating with communities, with Nicole Mace noting Winooski's monthly "merger study buddies" board updates (00:32:23).

Work Plan Timeline Adjustments and Data Collection Template: Kendra Sowers expressed concern about allocating sufficient time for data analysis in the work plan, leading to agreement on fast-tracking the foundations and shared vision phases to expand the options and analysis window (00:34:57). Lucia Campriello noted that regional asset mapping should incorporate financial, facility, and operational data strengths (00:36:00). Regarding the district data collection template, Clare Wool confirmed that Burlington's superintendent and finance manager reviewed the work plan as doable despite budget season. Seamus Abshere suggested centralizing state data pulling, but withdrew the suggestion after Nicole Mace explained that individual districts must review their own data to ensure correctness (00:39:41). Wilmer Chavarria and Seamus Abshere confirmed the template's feasibility for their respective districts (00:40:58). Nicole Mace instructed districts to complete the templates as soon as possible, ideally targeting early January to allow Craig Aarons-Martin to compile them for review at the January 4th meeting (00:41:56).

Regional Asset Mapping Protocol Overview and Formatting: Craig Aarons-Martin presented the Regional Asset Mapping Member Reference Tool, explaining its purpose to celebrate community strengths, identify scholar-facing programming, career and college pathways, community organizations, student services, specialized staff, facilities, technology, transportation, financial resources, leadership governance, and family engagement (00:44:37). Craig Aarons-Martin asked participants to explore community strengths, hallmarks, gaps (such as capped pilot programs due to funding), and governance structures (00:53:51). Responding to Nicole Mace, Lucia Campriello, and Clare Wool noting that a spreadsheet format was missing from the meeting packet, Craig Aarons-Martin committed to adding a spreadsheet template to the shared folder by that evening (00:50:05) (00:52:34). Craig Aarons-Martin outlined a "know, think, need" framework using examples from previous work in Boston regarding universal meals, transportation, arts, and physical education to illustrate how districts evaluate student supports and community impact (00:56:14).



District Asset Identification and Level of Granularity: Craig Aarons-Martin introduced a protocol to identify two or three important strengths and assets within school districts. Kendra Sowers raised a concern regarding the level of detail required for the exercise to be useful, noting that examples like a strong Career and Technical Education center needed more specifics on programs and sending school access (00:58:58). Lucia Campriello discussed the challenge of balancing macro-level pride with micro-level measurable outcomes (01:00:09). Seamus Abshere highlighted macro-level differences such as poor facilities in South Burlington and the lack of a Career and Technical Education center. Nicole Mace clarified that the exercise is designed to capture key merger-related investments, student outcome impacts, and gaps rather than cataloging every district asset (01:01:13). The committee agreed to walk through a concrete example to establish the appropriate level of granularity (01:04:45).



REFERENCE | ASSET AREAS

The six asset areas

Use these to think broadly, in committee and in community conversations.

Asset area	Strengths to consider
Educational opportunities	Academic programs, CTE, arts, enrichment, extracurriculars, effective instructional practices
Student services and supports	Special education, counseling, intervention programs, other student supports
People and expertise	Educators, specialized staff, school leaders, professional expertise
Facilities and resources	Buildings, technology, transportation, financial resources, operational systems
Community connections	Partnerships, traditions, local identity, community involvement, student belonging
Governance and organization	Leadership, governance practices, collaboration, administrative capacity

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Academic Offerings and Program Specificity: Nicole Mace requested an asset example to review, prompting Seamus Abshere to point out South Burlington's strong educational opportunities and course catalog, specifically mentioning they have approximately 27 Advanced Placement classes (01:05:57). Daniel Boyer noted that some community members feel 27 Advanced Placement classes are still insufficient. Kendra Sowers advocated for specific metrics to enable fair comparisons between districts, such as comparing 27 Advanced Placement classes to 10 in another district. Seamus Abshere reiterated that district weaknesses, such as lacking a Career and Technical Education center and having poor facilities, would also be meaningful to document (01:07:19). Nicole Mace shared an asset example from Wooki, highlighting a dedicated flexible pathways and work-based learning coordinator who connects students with dual enrollment, early college, and work-based learning opportunities (01:08:38). Kendra Sowers suggested creating a standard chart of academic offerings encompassing Advanced Placement classes, honors courses, foreign languages, and multilingual liaison classes to facilitate direct comparisons (01:10:04).

Public Transparency and Committee Confidentiality: Seamus Abshere raised the question of how districts should highlight weaknesses (01:11:04). Nicole Mace advised notifying school boards ahead of time to prevent community members from being caught off guard by published documents. Kendra Sowers expressed concern regarding confidentiality and community perception, emphasizing the need for a trusting space where discussion documents are not mistaken for final decisions (01:12:09). Clare Wool suggested that school board chairs report monthly that the study committee possesses no decision-making power and functions solely to conduct research and make recommendations for future voter consideration (01:13:18). Daniel

Boyer and Nicole Mace supported this approach, with Nicole Mace clarifying that as a public body, materials cannot be kept confidential and will be accessible on a public website, though small number suppression rules from the Agency of Education must be applied to avoid reporting identifiable data (01:14:32). Clare Wool emphasized that committee members must maintain professional collegiality and maturity when discussing district inventories publicly (01:16:41).

Review of Regional Asset Mapping Dashboard: Craig Aarons-Martin presented a digital dashboard dropped in the meeting chat that covers Burlington, South Burlington, and Wooki (01:18:47). The dashboard includes automated formulas and specific tabs for each community, populated with examples such as the Burlington Technical Center programs in health sciences, criminal justice, digital media labs, filmmaking, audio production, and digital photography (01:19:41). Craig Aarons-Martin explained that the tool is designed for community engagement to identify community assets, data points, and potential regional opportunities, and noted that all participants possess editing access to update their respective tabs (01:20:51). Nicole Mace and Clare Wool acknowledged the usefulness of the dashboard preparation (01:18:47) (01:21:59).

Prioritizing Educational Opportunities and Equity Lenses: Nicole Mace asked the committee to consider whether educational opportunities should serve as the primary lens for the asset mapping exercise (01:21:59). Daniel Boyer stated that academics and education should take precedence. Lucia Campriello agreed while noting that strategic plan and superintendent evaluation frameworks also measure leadership and community engagement, emphasizing that strong communication and leadership help build the voter support necessary to overcome cost and property tax concerns (01:23:01). Nicole Mace shared that the Wooki board prioritized educational opportunity alongside safety and belonging during a summer retreat (01:24:22). Lucia Campriello further emphasized that objective data must be coupled with qualitative reflections on student access, noting that high volumes of Advanced Placement classes have little value if historically marginalized groups face systemic barriers accessing them (01:25:25).

Upcoming Meeting Logistics and Document Management: Nicole Mace announced that the next committee meeting will be held in person on Monday, December 7th at 4:00 PM at Champlain Elementary School in Burlington, hosted in the library. Nicole Mace requested that Seamus Abshere follow up with Joe to secure a location for the January meeting in South Burlington. Seamus Abshere explained that website document management will be streamlined by using an inbox folder where participants can drop files to be published online within 24 hours (01:26:32). Seamus Abshere inquired about prior action on proportional representation, and Nicole Mace confirmed that action had already been taken. Clare Wool made a motion to adjourn, which was seconded by Kendra Sowers and approved unanimously (01:27:43).

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00:00:03

Nicole Mace: Hi, Greg.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Hey, how you doing?

Nicole Mace: I'm good. How are you?

Craig Aarons-Martin: I'm doing pretty well.

Nicole Mace: Good.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Yeah. How's the day traed?

Nicole Mace: I started my morning up in Stow, Vermont, which was nice. I had to go to a board meeting up there, so from a from a day job. Uh, so I feel like I've covered a lot of terrain today, but not as much as you cover.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Yeah. Yeah, I am. Um,

Nicole Mace: You're traveling today, right? Or you're in upstate. I remember you said you couldn't.

Craig Aarons-Martin: yeah. I Yeah, I went from uh New York to Jersey. So, I'm in Oakland right now. So,

Nicole Mace: Okay,

Craig Aarons-Martin: it's fine. Works. It works. You like,

Nicole Mace: that's good.

Craig Aarons-Martin: "Okay,

Nicole Mace: That's good. Well, thank you for, you know, bearing with me as I made all the adjustments uh last week. I I think hopefully this will go well and just in terms of setting getting everybody on the same page about the work plan and starting the asset mapping process.

00:01:18

Craig Aarons-Martin: yeah, I uh had an opportunity to do a deeper dive into it and really excited about it and it feels like folks will know this is what we're we're aiming to accomplish and um I think that that will create some reassurance for folks.

Nicole Mace: I think so. like and he and um I just added the um the questions log into the shared folder, but I do you know because I think people are everybody's coming at this with different you know questions and understanding and so just having a place where we can sort of keep ourselves organized around where we are today and where we're going to get to.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Mhm.

Nicole Mace: We don't have to answer all the questions right now. But we have a way to capture it. So, um, did you share you shared the work plan with Dave? Did he have any

Craig Aarons-Martin: He thought it was pretty pretty solid. he uh indicated that um we just wanted to make sure we had uh some flexibility as we get closer to a writing of the plan,

00:02:29

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Craig Aarons-Martin: but I think that if we frontload as much work as possible, it should totally be fine.

Nicole Mace: Yeah. Yeah.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Okay. So, we have Yeah.

Nicole Mace: Good.

Craig Aarons-Martin: So, we have uh Kendra, Luc Lucia or Lucia and Sheamusa.

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Craig Aarons-Martin: So, I can admit them.

Nicole Mace: Yes. Absolutely.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Right. There we go. Everybody. Hello. Hello.

Seamus Abshere: Hi everybody.

Nicole Mace: Hi.

Kendra Sowers: Hello.

Nicole Mace: Hi, Kendra. Long time no see.

Kendra Sowers: Hi, Nicole. Good to see you.

Nicole Mace: You too. Hi Lucia.

Lucia Campriello: Hi, how are you?

Nicole Mace: Good. How are you?

Lucia Campriello: I'm great. It's nice to see you.

Nicole Mace: Likewise. It's nice when you're, you know, doing a process like this and you with familiar faces,

Kendra Sowers: Agreed.

Lucia Campriello: Yes.

Nicole Mace: friendly faces.

Lucia Campriello: Yes.

Kendra Sowers: Agreed.

Lucia Campriello: And I'm looking forward, Craig, to meeting you and Sheamus as well.

00:03:38

Craig Aarons-Martin: Yeah, it is a pleasure.

Seamus Abshere: Yes. It's nice to meet you.

Craig Aarons-Martin: So,

Kendra Sowers: Greg, I love your shirt. It's like the fun shirt.

Craig Aarons-Martin: oh yes.

Kendra Sowers: We're going to have a great fun meeting.

Nicole Mace: That's right.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Oh, I love fall. This is the This is my season here.

Kendra Sowers: That's great.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Yes. I'm uh in like right outside of the state line in Jersey uh because I had to work with a a district today and like seeing all of the beautiful fall foliage as I was driving. H just amazing.

Nicole Mace: Yeah, you still have it's still down there. I was talking to my mom today. She's in Pennsylvania. She said, "We still have some color." like, "Oh, we're kind of into stick season up here." Unfortunately, it's Yeah.

Kendra Sowers: I've got the leaves all over my yard that have not been cleaned up. So, that's my version of fall at the moment.

Nicole Mace: Yeah. Exactly.

00:04:32

Craig Aarons-Martin: Me too. Me too.

Nicole Mace: Exactly. So, Craig, how does this work? So, we have folks sort of in the meeting and um but not visible to us or or or like I'm thinking if the superintendent are are attending, well,

Craig Aarons-Martin: Hello uh if they show up that we will

Nicole Mace: we know they're here or you'll let them

Craig Aarons-Martin: admit them.

Nicole Mace: in. Perfect.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Yeah, I can pin I can pin the members uh who are participating in this so that way that folks are pinned. So, just give me a moment.

Nicole Mace: Okay. Okay.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Um, and then everyone else will um Oh, you can only do three. Interesting.

Nicole Mace: Oh,

Craig Aarons-Martin: Okay.

Kendra Sowers: We look really big on the screen.

Nicole Mace: here we are.

Craig Aarons-Martin: We'll do Okay. I'm unpinning,

Nicole Mace: Okay.

Craig Aarons-Martin: but we will we'll figure it out. I'm more accustomed to this on um Zoom than I am on Google Meet. It's a mess.

Nicole Mace: Right.

00:05:44

Craig Aarons-Martin: Sorry,

Nicole Mace: Right.

Craig Aarons-Martin: but we'll I'll figure it out.

Nicole Mace: Thank you.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Okay. So, whenever you're ready, uh Nicole,

Nicole Mace: Well, we are waiting for Claire and Dan. And I'm just wondering, Kendra, do you know if Claire's planning to come? And Sheamus, do you know what dance status is?

Kendra Sowers: Claire is planning on coming.

Nicole Mace: Okay.

Seamus Abshere: I will message Dan and provide

Kendra Sowers: Yep.

Nicole Mace: Okay. So, I think we'll just hold for another minute or so and let give those guys time to join. Here's Dan and here's Claire.

Kendra Sowers: And there's

Craig Aarons-Martin: Yeah.

Nicole Mace: Wonderful. Okay. So, I think all the members of the merger study committee are here.

Craig Aarons-Martin: All right.

Nicole Mace: So,

Craig Aarons-Martin: It's a little port on me.

Nicole Mace: I will call the meeting to order at 4:03 p.m.

Craig Aarons-Martin: I don't know.

Nicole Mace: I sent out the agenda and it's been posted on the merger committee's website. Um, are there any changes that folks want to make to the agenda as part of agenda review and adjustments?

00:06:52

Seamus Abshere: I just had a question.

Nicole Mace: Okay,

Seamus Abshere: Did you guys decide on the proportional representation or do we need to take action on that tonight?

Nicole Mace: we are going to take action on that to we did make a decision, but it was not uh recorded as an action. So, we're going to sort of affirm the decision that um Claire and I made at the organizational meeting after you had to leave, Sheamus. was consistent with discussions we had had throughout the summer, but we do need to affirm it. That's item six on the agenda. 60C. Thank you. Uh any other questions about the agenda? If not, let's do a welcome and introduction for our new members. So our last meeting was really just an organizational meeting, one representative from each of the three participating districts in this study process. Um and uh at that time we did affirm sort of the approach we wanted to take to proportional representation and that meant we we have some new members joining us for our for this meeting today.

00:08:01

Nicole Mace: So I thought um we could just go around and say who we are. Some of us know each other, some of us don't. Um, Claire, would you like to kick us off with you and the Burlington delegation? Oh, you're muted. Sorry, Claire.

Clare Wool: Hi, my name is Claire Wool. I am the schoolboard chair of the Burlington School District. Um, and I am joined with Lucia Campriello and Kendra Sowers. Or, uh, is that what you want? Um,

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Clare Wool: I wasn't sure.

Nicole Mace: Or or Lucia and Kendra can introduce themselves.

Lucia Campriello: Awesome.

Clare Wool: Yes.

Nicole Mace: they want just I mean it'd be good to know just sort of how long you've been on the board.

Clare Wool: Yes,

Nicole Mace: Um that'd be helpful.

Clare Wool: that'd be great.

Nicole Mace: Thanks.

Lucia Campriello: I'm happy to jump in. Hi everyone. Lucia Campriello. Um I represent uh residents in Burlington in Ward 5, which is the South End um neighborhood in uh Burlington. and I'm on the same cycle as Claire, which means that I have one more year in my current term and I have been serving since uh April of 2022. Um and really happy to be joining this group already in progress.

00:09:10

Nicole Mace: Thank you, Lucia.

Kendra Sowers: Great. And I'm uh Kendra Sour and I am the North District School Commissioner, which is basically the new north end of Burlington. And this is my eighth year on the board and um I'm also the chair of the finance and facilities committee meeting and excited to be part of this. Thank you.

Nicole Mace: Thanks, Kendra. Sheamus, I'll turn it over to you next.

Seamus Abshere: Hey everybody, I'm Sheamus Abshere. I'm uh chair of the South Burlington School Board and I've been on the board now for two years, I think. Dan, you want to go?

Daniel Boyer: Dan Boyer. Um, been on the South Burlington School Board about the same time as Sheamus.

Nicole Mace: Great. Well, welcome. It's uh nice to meet you, Dan.

Daniel Boyer: Thank you.

Nicole Mace: I don't think I've I don't think I've met you before. I'm Nicole Mace. I'm the chair of the Wooki School Board. I've been on the board um three years, I think, at this point.

00:10:13

Nicole Mace: uh and I have uh two more years of uh of the term that I'm serving um currently. Um and I at our last meeting I was um elected to chair this committee. So thank you for thank you for the opportunity. uh my prior work life I did spend about 10 years at the VSBA uh during act 46 and so I do have a lot of hopefully relevant experience uh in terms of just the merger study process uh in Vermont and um so anyway uh happy to be welcoming our new members and um at this point I think we can see if there's anyone who wants to offer public comment. I do see we have the Wooki superintendent is here and uh one of our teachers is here. I don't know if either of you want to offer a comment. We're just here to listen.

Wilmer Chavarria: I'm just here to listen. Thank you.

Caitlin MacLeod-Bluver: Hi Nicole and hi everybody. This is Kaitlyn. I did want to offer public comment but due to child care and driving around I will not be able to.

00:11:25

Caitlin MacLeod-Bluver: So thanks for acknowledging me and I will shoot you an email. Um and if you want to share it with other people you're welcome to Nicole. Thank you so much. Sorry again.

Nicole Mace: that that no problem. And I think you know this committee will be meeting once a month and so um you can definitely submit your comments in writing or welcome to join us at a future meeting the first Monday of the month. Okay. At this point, we can move move to approval of the October minutes. Um, which I think just Sheamus, Claire, and I can um vote on because we were the ones that were there.

Clare Wool: Sure,

Nicole Mace: So, anyone want to make a motion to approve the minutes?

Clare Wool: I can. I make a motion to approve the October meeting minutes um that are on the agenda um for uh the merger study committee meeting.

Nicole Mace: Thank you.

Seamus Abshere: I reckon.

Nicole Mace: Thank you, Sheamus. Any discussion about those? All right, then. All those in favor of approving the minutes from our first meeting say I.

00:12:33

Clare Wool: I

Nicole Mace: I.

Seamus Abshere: All right.

Nicole Mace: I'll vote two. Okay. So, um, if you have the minutes open, I think it's a useful place for us to revisit some of the conversation we had at the organizational meeting for our new members. Um, so our next few items are really going to draw from content that's in those meeting minutes, including our committee operating principles, um,

Clare Wool: Sure.

Nicole Mace: which are number three. So, it's on I don't know the third page of the the minutes. I can share my screen if that would be helpful for folks just to see that. Okay. So this um and Craig I don't know if you have any you want to say anything here but this is um some operating principles that Craig brought to us that we reviewed in the meeting and all uh agreed to uh adhere by leading with students challenging ideas not individuals using evidence before conclusions presuming good faith honor local voice and regional responsibility and sharing responsibility for transparency. Just want to offer up an opportunity for anyone who has wasn't here last meeting to ask any questions or um give some feedback on those operating principles.

00:14:21

Nicole Mace: Not hearing any.

Kendra Sowers: I had a question about leading with students. So,

Nicole Mace: Sure.

Kendra Sowers: are are we getting student feedback? Are we involving them? How are we involving students in this process?

Nicole Mace: That's a really good question. I don't know. I can speak to how Wooki is involving students. I I think um we have two students on our school board. Um, and so we're dedicating the first hour of every schoolboard meeting for the next year to merger updates. Um and we've also developed sort of an activity for our student schoolboard members to lead with advisories in their schools. So um we have not talked about how this group would incorporate feedback from students. I think that is a conversation we can have around some of our um outreach uh strategies as part of the work plan.

Kendra Sowers: Okay, thanks.

Nicole Mace: Yeah, sure. Any other questions? I don't think we need to vote on it again, but it seems if people are pretty good, they can just sort of raise their hand or give me a thumbs up.

00:15:39

Nicole Mace: We can move forward. And again, we can always adjust these as needed, but it was useful for Craig to give us something to start from. um the good faith standard review. Uh again, Craig reviewed that um working guidance that was put out. Um and I think the high the highlights are are here. Good faith participation does not require us to support or oppose a merger. Um we should be challenging proposals, assumptions, and methodologies. You know, in other words, being fully engaged and agreeing or not agreeing with a specific direction that that's not um prohibited or that doesn't signal that you're not participating in good faith. It really means you're actively participating. Districts are sharing information when information is requested, communicating back with our local boards and communities. Any questions or feedback on that piece? Okay, I'm going to move us then to the proportional representation. So, um we had read the statute earlier this summer to require representation based on long-term weighted membership. The statute still refers to equalized pupils, which is sort of an old term, but our interpretation was that the legislature still intended representation on the merger committees to be weighted um as we do with our funding formula since that's what the statute said.

00:17:29

Nicole Mace: Uh so, uh actually, Superintendent Shavaria had presented um two scenarios based on the long-term weighted membership counts for each of the three participating districts. Um, scenario one would have had six committee members total. Scenario B or two would have had 10. Um, so we Sheamus had to leave early last um month. Uh Claire and I talked about based on the ability to maintain quorum, practical considerations of having a larger group um that we would go with scenario A, six representatives on the committee, which is why we have the group assembled we have today. uh because it was just me and Claire um having that conversation. I think bringing it back to the full group to sort of ratify that as an action and a decision uh seems like the right course of action. So, why don't we start with someone offering a motion to um have our merger study committee representation be scenario A as as recorded in the minutes and then we can discuss if we need to.

Seamus Abshere: Some moved.

Nicole Mace: Thank you, Sheamus. Any questions or comments about that?

00:18:54

Kendra Sowers: I agree with the smaller operating it it it will be we can get we have a lot of work to do and I think with fewer members that makes sense.

Nicole Mace: Great. Okay. Well, in this uh item, all members can vote. So, if there's no further conversation, um then we'll move to see who's in favor of Sheamus's motion.

Seamus Abshere: Were there a Did did anybody second it?

Daniel Boyer: Yeah, we need to second.

Nicole Mace: Do Do we need a second?

Clare Wool: I can second it. Yeah,

Nicole Mace: Okay.

Clare Wool: second.

Nicole Mace: Thank you, Claire. Now we can we can call for the vote.

Daniel Boyer: Yes,

Nicole Mace: All those in favor?

Daniel Boyer: I

Seamus Abshere: All right.

Kendra Sowers: Hi.

Clare Wool: H I

Nicole Mace: Okay, the motion passes. I will stop sharing my screen for now. Okay, great. Um the next item on the agenda is to review a draft work plan. So, um, in the folder of materials, you'll see there's a memo from the agency of education, um, which is really what sort of prompted well coming out of our last meeting where I think we all acknowledged we have about assuming we meet once a month, we've got about 10 months to do a lot of work or 10 meetings.

00:20:31

Nicole Mace: And um uh when Craig and I met to prepare for this meeting, he mentioned the fact that this memo had come out from the agency of education. And so which you know talks about some data that are currently available and data that will be available at some point down the road. Um, and so I really tried to just build a work plan that um hopefully moves us through the process of gathering information in a way that sets us up to to to deliver a report um a year from now, less than a year from now. So um and it and it incorporates uh what we got from the agency in terms of when data might be available. So, I'm gonna stop and I really am interested in folks like we should have a conversation about this. Does this make sense? Do folks have um you know concerns or questions about the sequencing um the focus, all that good stuff. We will

then take some time to look at the data template. But for now, I think just thinking about how we might organize the work so that I have a little bit of guidance in terms of agenda preparation.

00:22:07

Nicole Mace: And um Sheamus has his hand up.

Seamus Abshere: Are we? So, I really like the foundational and the shared vision as the starting, but I wonder if we should just briefly raise what the merger possibilities are because that might

Nicole Mace: Mhm.

Seamus Abshere: generate questions that lead, you know, that can help us in our data gathering.

Nicole Mace: Sure.

Seamus Abshere: If we wait till phase three to even say the words merger, we just might end up we realize that we need to actually have other questions and data uh collected.

Nicole Mace: That's a good point, Sha. So, when you say the options, um there's a there's a variety of different combinations. So, we're required, the three districts are required to study this together um and ultimately make a recommendation through a report uh that may or may not lead to a vote of our communities depending on what the recommendation is. Um but it's um so I think you're what you're saying is lay out perhaps during the foundations phase the different configurations that should be under review in the later phases of the work.

00:23:44

Seamus Abshere: I think so. I think it's it's kind of like breaking the ice. It's going to be this is a kind of a hard topic for us to talk about I think and members may feel like they need to hold back and until we kind of like have that first kind of difficult I I'm just kind of like thinking that we might want to break the ice on that pretty early so that then we have a lot of time on it.

Nicole Mace: Can you say a little bit more what it would look like to break the ice?

Seamus Abshere: So I view us as a group of elected representatives and our job is essentially we have to think politically. We have to ask ourselves what voters want, what residents want, what taxpayers want. And you know, another function that we have is to be analysts and kind of and and I think that if we start off by just having a go around the room to see where we think our communities are at and and what they would be surprised by um or or what they would be from this.

00:25:09

Seamus Abshere: I just think that to make further discussions um not beat around the bush. Uh just because like you said, we only have 10 of these meetings.

Nicole Mace: Right. Okay. Thank you. Anybody else have have a reaction to either what Sheamus said or to the work plan itself?

Lucia Campriello: Um this is Lucia from Burlington. Just to jump in and make sure that I'm understanding Sheamus your point. Um are you suggesting that like incorporated into the foundation space is a level set of either we walk through the world as three separate and distinct districts, we walk through the world as two separate and distinct districts, we walk through the world as one district. Is that what you mean by sort of those are the potential options or do you mean more so bringing forward at this early stage a sort of pulse check on what we think is reasonable?

Seamus Abshere: Think it's more the latter kind of a pulse check.

Nicole Mace: Okay. Others think that that's a useful step to go through at this stage.

00:26:32

Nicole Mace: I think the pulse the pulse check is this is really political.

Clare Wool: I think it would yeah and I think it would be you know our opinions are not I wouldn't feel comfortable that my pulse check would represent what you know I'm neutral based on presenting the facts alto together to see what if the goal of this the ultimate goal is cost savings then we are it's a study that we're presenting How? the uh the information to our communities and and then that information we would be then deciding once we've looked at all that information what Luca Lucia was just explaining.

Nicole Mace: Right.

Clare Wool: Um,

Nicole Mace: And I would I would actually put student opportunity up before cost savings.

Clare Wool: yes.

Kendra Sowers: Yeah.

Nicole Mace: What I would hope Yeah.

Clare Wool: Yes. Yeah.

Nicole Mace: We would speak to as well.

Clare Wool: I I agree.

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Clare Wool: I agree.

Kendra Sowers: I think it is important to have an that all of us are coming with an open mind to what the data points out and what we will learn because I I certainly am trying to do that with a really open mind trying to keep what's best for Vermont students and specifically the students in our district

00:27:47

Nicole Mace: Mhm.

Kendra Sowers: first um and then looking at what we can accomplish with um better services, you know, sharing services, costs, things like that. Um, so I just I feel like if we all can agree that we all will come with this open mind and ask a lot of questions and dig into the data and really see what we can accomplish, I feel like that's a shared vision to start with.

Nicole Mace: Thank you, Kendra. That's consistent with what Wooki school board has been. You know, we've had to present to city council and and and we've um invited members of our community to go through this process with us. I'm happy to share more details on that. But our our message has been the law requires us to do this and we're going to do so with an open mind and in good faith because irrespective of the sort of political swirl and I do think if we went and pulled people in the street cold on this question, it'd be all over the place. Um and it wouldn't necessarily be informed by the work that we're about to do over the next 10 months.

00:28:53

Nicole Mace: and that that this should be a conversation that all all three districts can have together and we'll learn a lot through the process. I'm hoping uh

Clare Wool: And I think I think before the committee I mean we were given the opportunity if we are if we were vehemmently opposed to this pairing they did give us that window. So Sheamus, if you and Daniel want to share, you know, if there's anything that you know, you from your school board or your community, that would have been the time to say, not that I'm I'm, you know, that we do not want to be uh with these two districts or we are struggling and again, no hard feelings, no judgments, but if that was your feedback, um I think that was the opportunity to um share that with the um with the committee. Um, does that does does that resonate with you uh Sheamus and Nicole that there was that time?

Nicole Mace: There was there was a time.

Seamus Abshere: Yes. Yes,

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Seamus Abshere: there was some time.

Clare Wool: Yep.

00:29:55

Seamus Abshere: Yeah. Yeah, I mean,

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Seamus Abshere: for what it's worth, the South Burlington School Board put a bus statement, I think it was almost a year ago, saying that we were we were open to, you know, we were looking forward to merger discussions uh as a way to improve student outcomes and performance for taxpayers. So, certainly not regretting the the group of districts we're with. We think you guys are awesome. So, that's it. Then it goes the other direction.

Clare Wool: Yeah. No, I even your superintendent had shared in the merger uh I had been to a bunch of those public meetings and he spoke on how he could help. Um so I appreciate that. Yeah, that's what I thought.

Nicole Mace: Yeah. And I I don't think it's a bad idea. I mean, I think I share concerns about trying to do a pulse check this early in the process because I do think it's going to be um who we've talked to and um you know could set us in a direction that if we're coming at this with an open mind and and willing to sort of go where the data take us um you know could not serve this process well.

00:30:58

Nicole Mace: But I but I do think Sheamus it is useful to articulate the the different options that we will be looking at from a configuration standpoint or that that are open to the committee. Um to Lucia's point, you know, three independent districts, two districts, one district. Um and um and we can we can weave that in as part of the foundation's work. So, we're being really transparent.

Seamus Abshere: Yeah, if we could just keep a balance where we're trying to get to the brass tax reasonably soon so that there's, you know, I I just I fear the the merger study proc process turning into a something that could be perceived from the outside as a kind of a bureaucratic dry non non-political I mean and if it was supposed to be that that's the CISA committee you know that's the operational superintendent questions and so I just think that we should bear in mind when can we bring in you know feelings um to this and and I'll just say that our school board is in a different position from your school boards because we we pass our budgets by 52%, 51%.

00:32:23

Seamus Abshere: And I think you guys pass it by anywhere from 65 to 80%. And so we just have a little bit more of a um you know

Nicole Mace: urgency.

Seamus Abshere: Yeah. Jump.

Nicole Mace: I can appreciate that. And you know, I also think it's useful to think about, you know, the role of this committee versus the role of the school boards in each of the participating districts. Um, and sort of how we're going to share information out with our communities. um and whether I've been thinking about that as not necessarily this committee's job like this committee's job is to articulate what are the questions look at the data ask more questions right start to narrow the field of options that we might want to recommend and kick the tires on them I think it is the school boards or commit you know however you want to set yourselves up um responsibility to be that link between this committ and the community. Um, because we're not going to have the bandwidth or capacity to do both things. Um, and so I think I'm doing a webinar for the VSBA in a couple weeks that talks about what the structure that Weski put into place.

00:33:45

Nicole Mace: Um, and I think I I don't know if I shared it with Claire and Sheamus, but I'm happy to share that with you all as sort of a monthly uh we have what we're calling merger study buddies um joining our board for the first hour of every meeting and um learning along with the board as I provide updates as the rep to the you know to the board um where the conversations are at and get feed feedback from the board and the community that way that I can then bring to these meetings trying to just be a little bit efficient. But I I think you're right, Sheamus, we the community is going to have a lot of questions and um everyone having a strategy for um as whether it's part of your budget process or whether it's part of a longer term engagement process that you have, letting folks in your community know what we're doing. And uh and why Kendra?

Kendra Sowers: Um, yeah, thanks for that. And when I'm looking at this framework, I agree with Sheamus about really being sure that we get to the data and the RAS tax of this all and looking at the timeline.

00:34:57

Nicole Mace: Mhm.

Kendra Sowers: You had some questions about the four phases of things like that. I was concerned that the options in the analysis was just a couple months and I wonder if we can um fasttrack foundations and shared visions so that we can get to the data the options. Like I I just want to be sure that we have enough time when we have the data that we need to really do a good deep dive because we will be answering to taxpayers and um our own constituents and everybody else. I I just want to be sure we had enough time.

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Kendra Sowers: That's all.

Nicole Mace: Yeah. And we will go through the data template. I think I'm partially trying to be mindful of the fact that we're in budget season and our administrative and you know a lot of our business managers and superintendents are sort of focusing there and so giving a little bit of breathing room but as far as I'm concerned if we all agree on the data template folks can start populating That for their district ASAP.

00:36:00

Nicole Mace: It's just sort of recognizing it may take a little while for all of the data to come forward. But I I think fasttracking data collection and then even the analysis piece um makes a lot of sense. Sorry, Lucia, you had your hand up.

Lucia Campriello: Yeah, I was just going to chime in and offer that I think when I look at the asset the re the regional asset mapping protocol whatever that document is called I think I see in that first step an opportunity to collect strengthbased data but also reflect finan like finances or facil ities or operations and financial resources as a component of that which I think would naturally capture Sheamus the

Nicole Mace: Mhm.

Lucia Campriello: really good point you're making which is if we don't have voter appetite to do something we've got to figure out how to embrace that piece of data within this uh framework that we're using and so I I just want to say I agree with everything that's been said and I I think I see in the first step of the asset mapping an opportunity to make sure that data like that is loud and There.

00:37:03

Nicole Mace: Great point. Thank you. And we are going to we are going to dive right into that piece um today. And then you know I thought it might make sense for us to go through the protocol make sure we all understand see if there's information we want to you know bring back in December recognizing that this is a virtual meeting and you know I wanted to make sure we at least have some agreement on a a a draft work plan and a data collection template. So we wouldn't have time to go through the full protocol, but that is in itself a data collection activity. Um so I'm happy to um revise the the months that we're doing sort of sort of compress the first two phases so that we give ourselves more time during options and analysis. Um, but it sounds like in general folks are comfortable or think the the the idea of a work plan could be helpful in organizing the work and obviously we'll have to tweak it as we as we get underway. Sheamus, I see a thumbs up.

00:38:23

Nicole Mace: Okay, so let's just take a second. I you know I'm not sure if anyone's had an opportunity to ask their administrative team to look at that data template. Um, again, as I was looking at the work plan, I was like, well, where are we going to put, you know, we need to give folks a common format and and definitions, so we could lose a lot of time with everybody reporting back numbers that that aren't defined the same way or um, so when I, you know, I I I I think in general eneral these data should be relatively straightforward. Um but but your sort of the administrators um for each district are certainly going to need to give feedback if this is not workable or feels like there's stuff here that we're asking for that they don't they don't have the ability to. Wilmer, do you want to I see you went off camera. We do have as a protocol we can invite members of our administrative team to to

Wilmer Chavarria: Not there.

Nicole Mace: chime in but um so I'll hold you for just a second while we'll let anybody else on the committee if they want anything to raise

00:39:41

Clare Wool: I I did speak with our Burlington superintendent and our finance manager looked both over the uh work plan. Again, aggressive but doable. uh recognizing budget season as well, but um doable and appreciative appreciative of the

Nicole Mace: Great.

Clare Wool: outline.

Nicole Mace: Great.

Seamus Abshere: So for the stuff that comes from the state, would it make sense to just have kind of divvy that up so that one staff person pulls it for all the districts? Um, you know, just for consistency to make sure that we're look, you know, pulling it from the same spot for everybody. So like for example on the demographics that are from the Vermont education dashboard,

Nicole Mace: Mhm.

Seamus Abshere: would it make sense to just have a single district do it for all of them and then a district a different district do it for like the um you know pulling the information from the school facilities dashboard?

Nicole Mace: Yeah, that's not how I set it up. I based on what I've heard in terms of feedback from our team, not on this specific topic, but data from the agency, I always like to have our own district eyes on it to make sure it looks right because there have been, you know, discrepancies over time.

00:40:58

Nicole Mace: So, I I sort of set each set this up so each district owns their own data and reports it back. But that's, you know, that's a good suggestion or that's a suggestion we can talk about.

Seamus Abshere: That makes a ton of sense. No, no, I I withdraw my suggestion. The uh efficiency at the cost of correctness is not a good idea.

Nicole Mace: Yeah. Yeah. Wilmer, did you want to uh say anything about your after looking over that template? I know I sent it to you, but we didn't really talk about it.

Wilmer Chavarria: uh no I I I I don't know why I had my camera on. I didn't mean I wanted to speak but yeah didn't mean to intervene.

Nicole Mace: Okay. I think it looks good from your perspective though, right?

Wilmer Chavarria: Yes. Yes.

Nicole Mace: Okay. You would have told me if it didn't.

Wilmer Chavarria: Yes.

Nicole Mace: Sheamus, did you have a chance to share it with Joe? I know Joe was on the email, so I'm not sure.

00:41:56

Nicole Mace: Did he give you any feedback about feasibility.

Seamus Abshere: No, no feedback. But Joe is a monster. He loves stuff like this.

Nicole Mace: I couldn't could anyone hear that? I couldn't I could Sorry, Sheamus. I couldn't hear you. Could you repeat that?

Seamus Abshere: No feedback from Joe.

Nicole Mace: Okay.

Seamus Abshere: I think this will be straightforward for him.

Nicole Mace: Okay. Okay. So, I would say, you know, uh if next step would be to turn this over to your district administrative team with the request that it be completed as soon as possible, recognizing we're in budget season. Um, but sort of no later than if we're going to stick to um Oh, of course, now I've lost my There's my work plan. If we're going to, you know, push the options and analysis phase to sort of January and February, then it would be great to have as much data, district provided data done as as possible sort of early January, knowing that the budget process is pretty much wrapped up by that point.

00:43:14

Seamus Abshere: Right. So just because it says needed for phase 4, we still want it now,

Nicole Mace: Just Yeah,

Seamus Abshere: right?

Nicole Mace: I would say get it down as as as quickly as we can. Yeah.

Clare Wool: to be discussed at our January 4th meeting. Got it.

Nicole Mace: Yes.

Clare Wool: Thanks,

Nicole Mace: in terms and at that point I think it's going to be what's missing what have we you know sort of uh Gre Craig has a compilation template so he'll be able to I think the most important thing to share with folks is don't delete rows because the master template is designed to have Craig just be able to copy and paste and then it'll sort of do some you know spreadsheet magic so um just complete the template as is and send it to Craig and he can compile it all. And I'd say at our January 4th meeting, we should plan to review the compiled data and you know make sure we have a plan to address any gaps. Okay. Anything else on the work plan or the data request?

00:44:37

Nicole Mace: If not, I'm gonna turn it over to Craig for the asset mapping protocol.

Craig Aarons-Martin: All right. So, can y'all hear me? Okay. Lot of really great rock music is going on in the backdrop here at the Starbucks. So, like I'm just trying not to sway with it. Okay. All right. With the fall leaves. Okay. Here we go. Let me let me act right. So, um I am uh going to move this asset mapping. I'm just going to do a quick overview and invite lots of really great conversation. Um I appreciate Nicole for being such a great thought partner in uh helping to co-construct some tools of support. So, I'm just going to uh share my screen. So, here we go. Let's do this. Do a tab. Here we go. All right. So, are you able to see the regional asset mapping member reference tool? Okay. Awesome. All right.

00:45:52

Craig Aarons-Martin: Here we go. So, So a question like why are we doing this? Um one because it's a great opportunity to celebrate all of the richness that uh that exists and resides within each community. Being able to identify the strengths and resources that our wonderful scholars across the entire region are experiencing. really inquiring about well what um what are some of the strengths of your community that you uh believe should be preserved, shared, possibly expanded and what does this actually mean for our work. So where is where are there opportunities that we're inviting each other into cur with curiosity about could there be some opportunities to expand some of these resources or opportunities or resources to other parts of the region and being able to just explore that. So, as part of your template, being able to just name here are some of the strengths that um that exist within our uh the region um that may be um solid scholar uh facing programming. So, not just sports and athletics and arts, but maybe you have a really great um career um college and career program or pathway.

00:47:09

Craig Aarons-Martin: Uh maybe there are community organizations that are also doing some incredible work in your community. but really being expansive as you explore what exists as a strength in your community um and being able to really share a little bit more context um with this particular group about well what are some of the things that we're super proud of in what we offer um and also have some curiosity about well what are some of the other regions offering other parts of the region offering that we may want to explore as well And so some uh particular um examples you might want to consider is any academic program, CTE, arts, enrichment, extracurricular um activities, anything that you our staff, our C. are leveraging. Um when we think about student services and support, um all of these are all known, but maybe you have a unique program model that also would be a benefit for us to explore as a region. And then when we think about who are the people who are at the the heart and the center of the work, especially um our educators, our specialized staff, our school leaders and professional expertise, the

facilities, knowing like Wooki had a great opportunity to visit uh Wooki and um the beautiful campus and just knowing what are some of the um uh tangible resources that we have as well in regards to buildings, tech, transportation, financial resources and systems.

00:48:41

Craig Aarons-Martin: and then community connection. So, who are some of the partners who we're working with um that help to shape um the culture, the traditions and um all centered on student and scholar belonging as well as family engagement. Um and then we also explore the leadership, governance practices, collaborations and administrative capacity um and really ex explore those uh elements. So, let me see. I believe in the uh in the folder you have um a um uh sheet you have an Excel spreadsheet that would in essence um be able to uh invite you to share here's our asset or here's a strength where does it exist um how is it benefiting the scholars and is there an opportunity for us as a region to really explore expansion or possibly a collaboration um and knowing that we just want you to be as uh excited and engaged with this and know that um the other part of this might be hey who is the person who stewards that work so that if uh we wanted to invite you know someone from our incredible CTE partnership to the conversation explore that in more depth and complexity um that we know who we are reaching out to.

00:50:05

Craig Aarons-Martin: So, I'll pause right here because I have a a couple more slides, but just wanted to lean in and see what your thoughts are about um the asset map mapping as an uh as a protocol and pro and activity and how this might um how your community may respond to a to a task like this.

Nicole Mace: Can I just say offer a clarifying? I think we have a we have a PDF in our packet. I'm not sure we have a spreadsheet.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Oh,

Nicole Mace: Maybe maybe it got sent to us in a different email,

Craig Aarons-Martin: sorry.

Nicole Mace: but it's not in the folder for today's meeting.

Craig Aarons-Martin: No worries.

Nicole Mace: So, Craig, if you can add that to the folder, I think that would be um very helpful.

Craig Aarons-Martin: We'll do. Uh yeah. So I, you know, sometimes you'll build something and then you sit with it and you're like, "Oh, I did share it and I have Not. So I literally will take the Google uh the uh PDF and I'll just turn it into a slide that uh

00:51:05

Craig Aarons-Martin: so that it's mirroring the very experience you have.

Nicole Mace: Oh yeah.

Craig Aarons-Martin: But thank you for that.

Nicole Mace: Yeah, sure. Um so any reactions or questions about this um process?

Seamus Abshere: I am looking forward to hearing what what your all districts view as your top strengths. This is exciting.

Craig Aarons-Martin: I can assist.

Nicole Mace: Yeah, I do think starting from a position of what we're proud of and what we're excited about makes a lot of sense. Claire, do you

Clare Wool: Oh, yeah. No, I I I appreciate the outline. I think this is um uh concise, and I like the I like how it frames everything.

Nicole Mace: So, how would we So, we talked about um maybe using today's meeting to share one or two examples so we can sort of get a feel for it and then again sort of take the work. You know, this ambitious work plan is really only going to work if we all sort of acknowledge we're signing up for some activity outside of these meetings, right? And so, um, you know, whatever process you might want to use to sort of populate, make sure at our December meeting, you're you're being you're able to bring your full asset set of assets to to to share.

00:52:34

Nicole Mace: Um, I think would be great. But, but I do think it's worth our time. Maybe we'll let Craig go through the rest of the slides, but to just throw out a couple of examples um to break the ice. Okay, Craig, you can keep

Craig Aarons-Martin: All right. Sorry. When again when your song comes on and you're like, "Oh my gosh." So what I will do is make sure that I have the uh I'm gonna make sure that as part of this folder there is the actual um would you all prefer a excel spreadsheet or would you prefer a dot? Um that way that I can make sure that by this evening you have that in your folder.

Lucia Campriello: I think a spreadsheet would make it a lot easier for all of us to contribute our ideas.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Okay. Anyone else?

Clare Wool: Yeah, agreed.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Okay. Awesome. All right. So, here are some questions to consider as you're exploring uh this uh at within your own communities. Here's some questions.

00:53:51

Craig Aarons-Martin: Doesn't mean that you have to like walk through each of these questions uh expansively, but here's some things to consider. What are some of of the strengths of your community that matter the most to your students uh your families and the communities. Two, what is it that you would love to just share as like this is a hallmark program or initiative that we use and here's the impact of that um program or initiative and here might be some uh something that we would love to explore in expanding or maybe you're already having those conversations and then we also want to explore well what might be some of the gaps. So there may be what you might say is hey we actually have this pilot program that is only reaching one school out of all you know three schools that have access to it. If we happen to have funding or if so we had a different partnership within a particular entity more uh young people or families or staff could benefit from such uh such a resource or an opportunity. And so just being able to name, hey, we have capped it at 20 students or we've capped it at 25 because we we're look we're waiting for more funding.

00:55:02

Craig Aarons-Martin: We're, you know, this might be um the organization we're partnering with only has capacity for, you know, this one program. Um and then what might be some of the strengths uh and structures of governance that you also want to consider in regards to preserving. So we will have to explore this question of what structures do we want to engage in to actually look at here are the strengths of um what we see in the region. here's some opportunities to expand some of those opportunities and how and maybe here is a some barriers that exist and maybe we want to look at what are some strategies that we've already leveraged and and used in order to address you know students or families that have been um uh who've become unhoused or maybe this is addressing uh students who need additional um literacy support because they're not reading on grade level. And so like looking at some of those as clear examples. And so a suggestion but not necessarily a tool you have to use, but is what is it that we know, we think, we need.

00:56:14

Craig Aarons-Martin: And so knowing that we h we know that these are some some of our supports and resources and strengths that we absolutely know and have evidence that absolutely are making dividends or making impacts. uh here's some of the things that we are actually thinking about that may actually be a strength for our community and here's where we are seeking additional support to explore this um even more broadly and being able to say to share like a we know we think we need um as an example um so in my capacity as a superintendent head of school we worked collaboratively with our um here in In Boston, we worked with the district around transportation and so we had to work with with them about scheduling. We had to work with them on uh after school programming and while transportation is something we know all of our scholars needed. We had to explore and needed additional data um for those after school programs or the before school programs and seeing whether what were the costs that uh that would need to be addressed if we wanted to run a before school program and we wanted to have it run through different parts of the community and region.

00:57:33

Craig Aarons-Martin: Um and we needed to actually have some like someone from transportation or a partner to help us explore that as a we need. Um, and an example of a we think um in the uh work that I did with Bill BPS is that we think that all young people uh in our school community should have access to arts and uh physical education and um also a that the district covers meals um for every scholar. And so that was a huge investment that we think really is a a core part of our our um strength as a district. And so we had to do a lot of work among partners in order to actualize that and knowing that every student would have access to arts every week, physical education every week, and then that we also made sure every young person had a lunch, a breakfast, and we also um universal uh free breakfast, lunch, and then a snack as well. Um and so like that was something that we knew uh that we we thought would be um an absolute support for the scholars we served and we found out that yeah absolutely we know that it is of benefit help with reducing chronic absenteeism and um also supported families that had very challenged uh financial pockets.

00:58:58

Craig Aarons-Martin: And so like just trying to give you a couple of examples of ways that um I have leveraged this in doing this work in um in Boston but would love to you know hear from you all about your thinking around applying this kind of a protocol in your own community.

Nicole Mace: Anybody want to jump in? I really appreciate these questions. I can imagine using my time at a board meeting next week, getting getting a little bit of feedback in that way. Kendra

Kendra Sowers: Yeah. Um, a couple of questions. Um, when I'm looking through this, our task was to identify two or three important strengths and I'm looking at all these categories and I'm wondering about the level of detail in order for this to be useful to all of us in the districts. Looking at the examples, I kind of feel like I would need a a lot more detail in the to drill down um in the examples.

Craig Aarons-Martin: She did. She

Kendra Sowers: So for example like a strong CTE center.

01:00:09

Kendra Sowers: Okay. But like really what programs why the access of the 14 sending schools you know what do we feel like about that CTE center is valuable? And so I just my question is is like the level of detail and two or three strengths for the size of the school districts that we have are that's hard that would be hard to choose. So anyway, just those are my thoughts in looking at this.

Lucia Campriello: Yeah, just to jump in and echo,

Nicole Mace: Thank you.

Lucia Campriello: um I found myself like of course brainstorming a million different things that I'm so proud of about Burlington School

Craig Aarons-Martin: Thank you.

Lucia Campriello: District and then simultaneously stepping back a little bit to think about um of those things, what which of them can I um connect to measurable outcomes? And so I feel like I'm vacasillating between programmatic things that make us feel really good that we know are generating positive impact as well as measurable outcomes and there being

Craig Aarons-Martin: f******

Lucia Campriello: fewer of those things that I think we can crisply and discreetly measure.

01:01:13

Lucia Campriello: So I I just I'm thinking about how to best balance the sort of macro and micro in this exercise.

Nicole Mace: Sheamus.

Seamus Abshere: I think that differences between our districts might point to more macro things like, you know, I I'll just get real about it. I mean, we have pretty bad facilities here in South Burlington.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Hey,

Seamus Abshere: Um, but we have, you know, I think I would say really good other things. Um, and then like we don't have a CTE. So, like there's I feel like at the macro level there are some pretty big differences between the districts and that might be part of what we're trying to elicit here.

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Lucia Campriello: That's helpful.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Let's

Lucia Campriello: Thank you.

Nicole Mace: Yeah. I don't so um I do think if there's something that

Craig Aarons-Martin: start.

Nicole Mace: you're you I don't know that it needs to be a catalog of all the things all the assets in the district but I do think um when I read it these questions it's sort of like in the context of this merger conversation what are the the the assets or the investments that we're making as districts that we're really that are showing, you know, have impact and um matter to to to us as districts that we want to make sure we're capturing that without saying we have to capture all all the things.

01:02:55

Nicole Mace: Um, and where are some of the gaps that we think we do need we we want to put on the table. So Sheamus has put facilities on the table. I would put limitations of a really small high school on the table in terms of the course offerings. um in addition to sort of the things that we um have you know everyone at this table I'm sure spending time over you know on how are we making an a difference in terms of student outcomes and that has meant investments in things like curriculum in things like additional supports for students.

Craig Aarons-Martin: That's

Nicole Mace: So lifting up those investments and talking about why the board it's important to preserve them I think is the point

Craig Aarons-Martin: Shoot.

Nicole Mace: of this exercise even knowing you know it's not the only data set we're going to look at in terms of you know down the road is merger good is merger you know but it's but to me it's a really like setting the table of the things that um each district is really seeking to preserve and what what gaps there might be that would we should focus in on as we start to get further down the road is that and again I think in addition to sort of the raw numbers piece that we just

went through in terms of that template this is another way for us to start to capture the sort of more uh programmatic pieces that aren't captured by

01:04:45

Nicole Mace: that other data template. Do do folks feel like it would be useful to like really walk through one example or um have an example to in terms of you know Kendra your point of like some of this seems really high level and I'm not even sure what it would tell us um sort of what's the right level of granularity or detail we we should be striving for collectively as we go off and do these

Kendra Sowers: Yeah, I mean I think I I think it would be helpful that we all if we had like a one idea and then we kind of look at that level of granularity or or not or at the macro level of what we're looking for would be helpful for me.

Nicole Mace: Yeah, I think that I mean we've got 28 minutes. I think we we could walk through an example together uh so we're just sort of on the same page about what we might want to come back with. Sheamus is a thumbs up. Do you want to say anything, Sheamus?

Seamus Abshere: Nope.

01:05:57

Seamus Abshere: No. All wit.

Nicole Mace: Okay.

Craig Aarons-Martin: That's it.

Nicole Mace: Okay. Um, so does anybody have a strength or an asset that would be good for us to throw on the table to walk through as an exercise?

Seamus Abshere: I think we have really strong educational opportunities in South Burlington.

Nicole Mace: So you mean like course offerings, course catalog.

Seamus Abshere: Yes.

Nicole Mace: Okay.

Seamus Abshere: Very strong course catalog.

Nicole Mace: How would we define strong?

Kendra Sowers: Is that the right the amount of courses, the level of courses, the Yeah.

Seamus Abshere: Yeah, good point. I think what I mean to say is that if what you're looking for is strong academics, I think that we have the teaching staff,

Craig Aarons-Martin: What's up?

Seamus Abshere: the tradition and the cat kind of the established catalog that uh would certainly indicate that that's one of the strengths of our district.

Nicole Mace: What if we what if we dialed it down even further like number of AP classes,

Seamus Abshere: Right. I think we have like 27 or something like that.

Nicole Mace: right?

01:07:19

Daniel Boyer: And some people say that's still not enough.

Kendra Sowers: But that is, I think, the level of granularity that I'm kind of looking for because I think we could all say we have really great classes, but it would be like like how do you compare apples to apples and oranges?

Nicole Mace: right?

Kendra Sowers: If we you had 27 and we had 10, that's a great distinction, right? Or we offer, you know, other classes that you don't offer. So, I think we do want to get a little specific, not get down in the weeds,

Nicole Mace: Yep.

Kendra Sowers: but enough that we can understand the differences of our of our districts.

Nicole Mace: Right.

Seamus Abshere: Right. And there's going to be I mean and I think that's why there's also the the weaknesses of each district is going to be a very uh meaningful section. You know, I think that the fact that we don't have a CTE and that we have uh pretty bad facilities are going to be things that stick out. And then, you know, other districts might not have as many foreign languages as we do, you know, and other districts might not have as many AP classes as we do.

01:08:38

Nicole Mace: So I think the the prompt then is if we're going to list something as an asset that we describe it in enough detail that whether it's sort of numerically it there can be some comparisons made um you know and and not all districts will have AP course offerings to put on the table to to compare to or um you know the thing that occurred to me is we have uh in Wooki a flexible pathways and work-based learning coordinator that has done incredible work to um connect students with opportunities that don't exist within the high school whether that be um you know dual enrollment, early college, whether that be a work-based learning opportunity.

And so you know other districts may not have a dedicated role designed to that function. Um, but that would be the level of specificity that I think I would bring is is sort of this is a position or an investment that we're making and here's how it benefits students and here's what it may or may not be able to um how how that could translate to a regional opportunity.

01:10:04

Nicole Mace: Um,

Clare Wool: Yep.

Nicole Mace: Claire, does that make sense to you?

Clare Wool: Yeah. I think I think we might see, you know, just a show of hands like duplicity like all three of us. I think Sheamus uh or you know SB we have the same and I'd just be curious of you and then we'll be able to see what negates you know if all three of us have it then that's something that all three of us admire and want to retain.

Nicole Mace: Right.

Clare Wool: Um yes you guys have one. Okay.

Kendra Sowers: Yeah,

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Kendra Sowers: and I think the point about academic excellence is really in interesting and wanting to offer the most for our students. And I think it would be worth it as a deep dive into because this is all about the students and what they're learning is to look at how many AP, how many honors, who's offering the foreign language, who's offering the multilingual leaison classes, like all the pieces that we know create a rich environment for our students. We actually all know them.

01:11:04

Kendra Sowers: So,

Nicole Mace: Right.

Kendra Sowers: it would be great to like even do a chart of our academic offerings. Like, we could all do that and then compare. And I think that would be amazing because I'd love that data. Um, so that could be like we all I think we all are proud of some of our academics and know we need to increase maybe in other areas, but maybe we come up with kind of a standard chart that we fill in because I do feel like that's super important. That's like core to education is the classes

that we offer um and the supports behind the classes and then the different pathways that they can choose beyond the regular curriculum.

Nicole Mace: Yep.

Seamus Abshere: And and how do you all

Clare Wool: And then away from Go ahead. Go ahead.

Nicole Mace: Go ahead, Sheamus.

Seamus Abshere: how do you all want to highlight those weaknesses? Because certainly there's a lot of put on the board for the good things that our schools do. But I feel like, you know, obviously there's there's stuff that our school board knows about that are problems.

01:12:09

Seamus Abshere: And so, how do how do we want to how does the committee feel like highlighting those?

Lucia Campriello: Yeah.

Nicole Mace: I I think the frame that Craig shared was sort of strengths and gaps, right? And I think we can feel safe populating that. And I but I would also again encourage you to let your boards know this is an activity we're do I don't want any board member to be caught off guard by a document that this committee is reviewing right that what do you mean you put put out into the world that we might need to work on this that or the other. So, just you all figure out the best way to make sure nothing we do here is going to be uh a surprise.

Kendra Sowers: But that's actually a really good point and a good question I guess I have about confidentiality and

Nicole Mace: Mhm.

Kendra Sowers: the things that we discuss here that have absolutely we're not making decisions but we should have a a

Nicole Mace: Right.

Kendra Sowers: trusting space to uh talk about things and not that any decision is being made.

01:13:18

Kendra Sowers: And I would hate for our communities to feel like we're making decisions when we're actually just throwing spaghetti at a wall and looking at everything that's there. And um so I guess I would ask what's what's the confidentiality of the material that we're doing and how can we all agree what's being put out

Nicole Mace: Mhm.

Kendra Sowers: because yeah I just don't want communities to feel like there's any decisions when there's not in a discussion document.

Nicole Mace: Right.

Clare Wool: I think by I like what uh you know I'd be curious what Sheamus uh and Daniel say about starting you know whether it's starting your meeting your schoolboard meetings every month or included in your chair's report or somewhere on your agenda where you're talking about the mergers that you always repeat this is a study committee there they there there is no power within this committee. They are doing the work of you know uh the research involved that is to presented but it is a community decision in the end and this is a study uh study committee you know and that it again just keeps reiterating that no decisions have been are are made at this only recommendations you know at the end but that's in this next summer.

01:14:32

Clare Wool: So, at this point, if there are any concerns, um, I don't know, that was just a suggestion.

Daniel Boyer: No,

Nicole Mace: Yeah,

Daniel Boyer: that's an that's an excellent point. I mean, we don't have that power. So, just keep telling people at our meetings that yes, we continue to meet. We continue to come up with recommendations, but ultimately it's going to be the voters and Montpelia that make the decision.

Clare Wool: Mhm.

Nicole Mace: That's right. And you know to directly to your question, Kendra, I think as a as a public body, we don't really have the ability to keep things confidential. I think you should make sure you're working with I mean most of what we're going to be talking about is a matter of public record. Whether or not it's all, you know, presented in a in a in a single forum is, you know, that's that's different. But I agree. I think we're this is really the committee is just gathering information. We should be encouraging administrators and I think the instructions say, you know, use the small number suppression rules that the that the AOE has out for reporting data.

01:15:41

Nicole Mace: So don't report data that is, you know, could be identifiable. Um um but this is a public process. Um,

Clare Wool: Mhm.

Nicole Mace: and so just be be mindful of uh, you know, we have a website that we've created and the meeting materials are going to be on the website and so if folks from the community are interested in knowing what we've been looking at. Um, and I think we did a pretty good job, Sheamus. Thank you again for building that site to say like we're just this is a study, you know, that's what this is. Um, and um, so but thank you for the question, Kendra, because I think it's good that we're mindful of that. Oh,

Clare Wool: Yeah.

Nicole Mace: you're m you're muted, Kendra. Sorry.

Kendra Sowers: Yeah, I just think it's good to all be on the same page of like how we're communic communicating to our boards and to the public and what we're doing and just so that we're all, you know, we're all on this together and helpful,

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

01:16:41

Clare Wool: and and it requires maturity. You know that we're not saying I can't believe Wooki has 18. Wait, what did the governor say? 18.

Nicole Mace: 17 languages that we teach.

Clare Wool: I'm joking. But that maturity of collegiality that what we're

Kendra Sowers: right?

Clare Wool: sharing is we certainly aren't bragging about what we have. We are nervous like South Burlington's nervous like Wooki's nervous. We are always terrified even though we've you know the our last couple years we have been able to pass our budgets. Really that's because we didn't have a high school. I'm digressing a little bit but we're a district that I came on with Kendra because our teachers went on strike and so we're always in that fragile um balance I feel like that we're all a part of. So, in this exercise, which it is healthy to do and do an inventory, um to Kendra's point, that we're not walking away from it saying, "Wow, you know,

Nicole Mace: Right.

Clare Wool: to our peers or even in public at our meetings, like, can you believe Wooki has this or we don't have this or they have that." I I agree.

01:17:48

Clare Wool: I think it's great to call that out because it isn't confidential. It should be in the minutes. And the best part is, like we all agree, we're not making decisions. We're just gathering everything. So, sorry I'm repeating myself, but um I could see how it could be damaging if within this group we present it in um ways that aren't healthy.

Nicole Mace: Right.

Clare Wool: Yeah.

Nicole Mace: Absolutely.

Clare Wool: Professional. Yeah.

Nicole Mace: And that that goes back to our sort of commitments that we agreed to make.

Clare Wool: Yes.

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Clare Wool: Yeah.

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Clare Wool: Well, thanks. I appreciate I know Craig put something in. I appreciate appreciate the preparedness for this meeting to be able to see those sheets um to be able to, you know, move on and and continue our work over the next four weeks to be prepared for our December meeting um with that information. Um, and I

Nicole Mace: Yeah, at this point we'll we'll actually have a full month before our next meeting.

01:18:47

Nicole Mace: It was pretty a tight turnaround between our last meeting and this one. So,

Clare Wool: that's of all that you've got done,

Nicole Mace: um,

Clare Wool: Craig and Nicole, for this and and Sheamus for this meeting.

Nicole Mace: yeah, thanks again, Sheamus, for the website stuff. That was very helpful.

Clare Wool: Yeah.

Nicole Mace: Um, anything else on the regional asset ma mapping? Craig, you said you put some stuff in the I I can see the dashboard and the deck are in the folder for

Craig Aarons-Martin: Yeah.

Nicole Mace: this meeting.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Yes.

Nicole Mace: Anything else you want to share based on what you heard us talking about?

Craig Aarons-Martin: Yeah. Yeah. So, I uh went ahead and took a moment. Um I'll just quickly, if you're okay, give me a couple of seconds.

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Let me find a tab. Here's a dashboard. So, um and I dropped it in the chat. it's in a folder. Um, so here's just a dashboard that covers all three uh communities.

01:19:41

Craig Aarons-Martin: And so, um, just so that you have a sense of the t uh of what what's here, all of this is encoded with formulas, but ultimately the guide is, hey, open up your tab, which is here on the bottom. You have Burlington, South Burlington, and Wooki. Check out the example. So, if we look at Burlington, um, and this may or may not be true, but you know, being able to say, hey, an asset area might be educational opportunities and looking at Burlington's technical center programs for health sciences, criminal justice, digital media, um, where does it exist? So, knowing that they're sharing a building at at the new Burlington High School, maybe that is or is not true, but how is it benefiting students? So this is about career and technical um programs that young people have access to in these particular um areas of criminal justice, digital media labs, film making, audio production, digital photography. Why is it worth preserving? Um well, it may be because now it has a a home, but you might feel like it's preserving because you actually have data and statistics that really say this is how many students are going into these programs or careers.

01:20:51

Craig Aarons-Martin: Um, and that is a data fact that you want to make sure is anchored. As an example, is this something that we could share across the region? definitely possible. Where did this actually come from in regards to a source? And then these are some of the examples that I added today. So, just to give you examples that you could work from, feel free that you can go into the yellow um sections and add whatever you desire, but it's just an opportunity to really engage your community and really celebrating these are the parts of our community that we really love, la, and adore. We want to preserve them and we would love to explore what this could look like more regionally in conversation. And so there is a tab for South Burlington and there is one for Wooki. If there's anything you see here that is inaccurate or you would want to update, everyone here has access editing access. So you can edit this, you can share it with folks to complete it. um and know that this is a community tool we're using just to again support the work for this committee.

01:21:59

Nicole Mace: Thank you, Craig.

Clare Wool: Great sample. Yep.

Craig Aarons-Martin: And if anything happens with the the formatting or something like this, don't worry about it because I know some of us get upset like, "Oh my god, how am I going to fix it?" Don't you worry. Don't you worry. You find your tab and you you just get to it.

Nicole Mace: Just focus on your tab.

Craig Aarons-Martin: Yeah. So, I pause to see if there's any questions because uh I just wanted to make sure this is the tool that uh everyone can work from. If you want to make a copy and you all want to engage in it on your own with your community, feel free. But this is something any uh anyone from your teams can also edit and use.

Nicole Mace: Thank you. So, our goal is to have this populated uh with as many relevant examples. Um, and I think, you know, Kendra was putting out a plug to sort of really focus on academic or educational

Craig Aarons-Martin: Sorry.

Nicole Mace: opportunities.

01:23:01

Nicole Mace: How do folks feel about that being a primary lens? Um, or do we want to, again, this is not going to catalog all the things that we do. It's really the things that we want to make sure we lift up to this committee as either promising models or things that are really important to the community to preserve.

Daniel Boyer: Academics education should come first.

Nicole Mace: Anyone else want to weigh in on that?

Lucia Campriello: I'm thinking a Oh,

Clare Wool: Yeah,

Lucia Campriello: sorry. Go. No,

Clare Wool: go ahead.

Lucia Campriello: go ahead.

Clare Wool: No, you go ahead.

Lucia Campriello: Oh,

Clare Wool: Thanks.

Lucia Campriello: I was just going to say I'm thinking a little bit about our strategic plan framework and also the superintendent evaluation framework that we use which measures on like leadership and community engagement in addition to academics and I agree with prioritizing academics. Um because I think there's some other pieces that absolutely have to be in place in

order for those academic programs to be delivered effectively. Um and I think that also speaks to some of the things that came up earlier around like voter support um and appetite, right?

01:24:22

Lucia Campriello: like when communication and leadership are working well and academic outcomes uh are moving in the right direction then I think we have uh the ability to overcome other shortcomings like property taxes and costs and everything else. So, I don't know where those things fit in, but those are just things that are coming to mind. And I'm again just trying to think of like other useful frameworks that we can leverage um in helping us kind of sift through and consolidate what are so many bright spots for all of us.

Nicole Mace: Yeah, I'll I'll share a little um the Wooki board at our retreat this summer did um we calling it a values and tradeoffs exercise. So we, you know, I think most people if you ask them, do you want better educational opportunities? Do you, you know, it's like yes to all. Um, and in some cases, uh, some of the values or the things that we think we want may be in conflict with one another. And so it's an activity designed to really sort of flesh out a little bit more sort of what are the most important values, what are the sort of red lines.

01:25:25

Nicole Mace: Anyway, so our board came away from the retreat prioritizing educational opportunity and safety and belonging as two values that were really important to our community and um we're going to be doing more of that activity out in the community. We were like, well, that's just the board's take. We want to make sure we get other people's takes on this. Um uh so I I I agree educational opportunity is important but I think I just so folks know I'm also going to bring this lens around safety and belonging which I think is really important to our to our board and our students

Lucia Campriello: Yeah. And sorry, I don't mean to take extra air time, but I agree with that. And I was thinking also about like ensuring that we couple the objective data with qualitative reflections, particularly around access to these opportunities.

Nicole Mace: Yeah.

Lucia Campriello: So like 27 AP classes is awesome if you know students of the global majority or students who qualify for free and reduced lunch or other historically marginalized groups have trouble accessing those classes because of whatever systems and biases exist.

01:26:32

Lucia Campriello: Um then the volume doesn't much matter.

Nicole Mace: Yeah. I think we're I think I have a pretty clear understanding of what the assignment is. Is everybody else feeling pretty good?

Clare Wool: Yes.

Seamus Abshere: Yep.

Nicole Mace: And we'll be in person in December. Burlington will be hosting us.

Clare Wool: Yeah. We're going to be at Champlne Elementary School. um on that uh December uh meeting date. um at 4 o'clock. Okay, great. In the library.

Nicole Mace: And then I'm wondering if our friends in South Burlington can help us find a location for our January meeting.

Seamus Abshere: Yes,

Nicole Mace: You don't have to say what it is now,

Seamus Abshere: we sold the cat.

Nicole Mace: but Sheamus, I would ask you, maybe you can follow up with Joe and see what might work for January.

Seamus Abshere: Yes.

Nicole Mace: Excellent. any other next steps that folks want to discuss? I think in just in terms of the posting of the minutes and all that, um Sheamus has given Craig, right, access to be able to put documents on our website.

01:27:43

Seamus Abshere: So, what I'm going to do,

Nicole Mace: Is that how

Seamus Abshere: I'm just going to have an inbox folder and anytime you want anything posted on the website, anybody, you just drop it into the inbox and I'll try to have it online in like 24 hours or

Nicole Mace: amazing.

Kendra Sowers: That's great.

Nicole Mace: We're very lucky to have you, Sheamus. At the VSBA conference last week, people were really tied up in knots over over this website issue. So,

Clare Wool: Thank you.

Nicole Mace: I felt very fortunate. We have we have some techsavvy folks in our among us.

Clare Wool: Thank you.

Nicole Mace: All right. Well, if if there are no other next steps, I think um I could entertain a motion to adjurnn.

Daniel Boyer: Just one I just want to confirm the next one is uh Monday, December 7th, 4:00 Champlain Elementary School.

Clare Wool: Yes,

Nicole Mace: Yes.

Clare Wool: correct.

Seamus Abshere: Did Nicole, did you I'm sorry if I missed it, but did you want to go back to the proportional representation and take action on that or did we a degree agree we didn't need to do that?

Nicole Mace: I think we did take action on that.

Seamus Abshere: Oh, yes, we did.

Nicole Mace: We We did.

Seamus Abshere: Okay, great.

Nicole Mace: Thank you.

Clare Wool: Yeah.

Nicole Mace: We certainly wouldn't want to have two meetings go by where we So, thank you for that.

Clare Wool: If we're all set, then I'll make a motion to adjurnn.

Nicole Mace: Thank you, Claire. Is there a second?

Kendra Sowers: I'll second.

Nicole Mace: Thank you, Kendra. All those in favor.

Clare Wool: I

Daniel Boyer: All right.

Seamus Abshere: Hi.

Nicole Mace: All right, folks. Have a great rest of the month and we'll see you in December.

Clare Wool: thank you so much everyone.

Kendra Sowers: Thank you so much.

Nicole Mace: Okay.

Daniel Boyer: All right.

Kendra Sowers: Great meeting.

Nicole Mace: Bye.

Kendra Sowers: Bye.

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